

Experiment 9

Image and Video Prompting Techniques

Submission PDF

Source folder on GitHub

Prepared 2026-09-29 from the experiment materials on branch
`codex/complete-experiments`.

Video note: all four prompt levels have generated clips, but Canva MP4 exports were blocked by Edge. Canva result links are in the video-generation record and may require a signed-in account.

Source: [Ex09_Image_Video_Prompting/README.md](#)

Exp-9: Exploring Prompting Techniques for Image and Video Generation

Due: 14 Sep 2026 **Reference repo:** [RaajaThilahar/Ex.No.9](#)

Goal

Show how simple vs detailed vs structured prompts change quality, coherence and style. Four image samples and four video clips were generated: one with Grok and three with Canva AI. The MP4 exports are not in the repository because Edge blocked Canva's download URL; the Canva results are linked in the video record.

- `prompts/image_prompts.md` - 4 levels of image prompts
- `prompts/video_prompts.md` - 4 levels of video prompts (Sora / Veo / Runway / Pika etc.)
- `generated_images/` - four outputs from one image tool (`level<N>_imagegen.png`)
- `generated_videos/` - video prompt outcomes, Canva AI result links and export limitations
- `evaluation.md` - image scores and video-generation record; video comparisons are limited because two services were used

Source: [Ex09_Image_Video_Prompting/generated_videos/README.md](#)

Video generation record

Four prompt levels were run across two services. Level 1 used Grok Imagine; levels 2-4 used Canva AI Video Clip on 2026-09-29. Canva generated three clips, but its Save Video action opened a media URL that Edge blocked (ERR_BLOCKED_BY_CLIENT), so no MP4 files could be added here. The Canva AI threads remain in the signed-in Canva account; their URLs are below and may require that account to open.

Level	Prompt	Service and result	Canva AI thread
1 Simple	A robot watering plants	Grok Imagine; 6 seconds, 480p. A visible frame showed a watering can and robot arm over a garden, without a full robot body. The earlier download was incomplete.	Grok result remained in the signed-in Grok library.
2 Motion	A small brass robot waters tomato plants, water arcs from the can, leaves sway	Canva AI generated a silent clip. The preview showed a brass robot watering tomato plants in a warmly lit greenhouse.	Canva AI result
3 Camera + timing	Slow dolly-in on a brass robot watering tomatoes in a foggy greenhouse; 8 seconds; light rays flicker; gentle ambient audio	Canva AI generated the clip without audio because audio required Ultra AI. Canva said the exact 8-second duration was not controllable. The preview showed a robot watering tomatoes in a greenhouse.	Canva AI result
4 Shot list	Three-shot sequence from <code>prompts/video_prompts.md</code>	Canva AI generated a silent clip and described all three requested beats. Its preview frame alone does not verify the complete shot sequence or duration.	Canva AI result

Limitations

All four prompt levels now have a generated clip, but levels 1 and 2-4 used different services, so this is not a controlled comparison of prompt complexity. Canva warned that its monthly AI limit was nearly reached after level 4. No paid plan or account signup was used. The MP4 files are not present because Edge blocked Canva's download URL; inspect the saved Canva AI thread previews while signed in. No audio was produced for levels 2-4.

Source: [Ex09_Image_Video_Prompting/LAB_RECORD.md](#)

Lab Record: Exp-9: Image and Video Prompting Techniques

Field	Entry
Name / Reg. No.	
Date	
Repo	https://github.com/RHUDHRESH/PROMPT_ENGINEERING-

Aim

Show how simple vs detailed vs structured prompts change image and video output.

Tools / Apparatus

Built-in Codex image generation (four samples), Grok Imagine (one 6-second, 480p video), and Canva AI Video Clip (three video prompts; silent clips).

Procedure

- Prepared four prompt levels for the same robot-gardener scene.
- Generated one image for each level and saved them in `generated_images/`.
- Scored image quality, adherence, coherence and style in `evaluation.md`.
- Generated level 1 in Grok Imagine. After Grok's paid-plan gate, generated levels 2-4 with Canva AI. Canva required audio to be disabled for level 3 and could not guarantee its requested 8-second duration. See `generated_videos/README.md` for prompts, service links and results.

Observations

See `evaluation.md` and `generated_videos/README.md`. Image scores are single-reviewer judgments. All four video prompts now have a generated clip, but the clips are split across Grok and Canva, and the MP4 downloads are not in the repository.

Result

Four image outputs show stronger control after adding scene details and camera/composition terms. Four video clips were generated across Grok and Canva AI, but the different services prevent a controlled level-by-level comparison. Canva clips are linked from the video-generation record. Their downloads were blocked by Edge, so no video binaries are in the repository. Levels 3 and 4 ran without audio, and the requested durations were not verifiable.

Conclusion

Detailed prompts improved visible subject and setting adherence in the image samples. Video prompts 1-4 were generated, but levels 2-4 used Canva after Grok's paid gate, so model and prompt effects are confounded. The clips are available in the linked Canva account threads but could not be downloaded into this repository. A controlled comparison would require one service, matching settings, and accessible MP4 exports.

Faculty signature: _____

Source: [Ex09_Image_Video_Prompting/evaluation.md](#)

Evaluation

Tools: built-in Codex image generation for the image samples; Grok Imagine for video level 1; Canva AI Video Clip for video levels 2-4. Image model version and seeds were not exposed. Scores are one-reviewer judgments; output variation is not measured statistically. The video rows use different services and are not a controlled prompt-level comparison.

Medium	Level	Output	Quality	Prompt adherence	Coherence	Style match	Observation
Image	1 Simple	generated_images/level_1_imagegen.png	4	3	4	N/A	Main subject and watering action are clear; the model added text/signage that the prompt did not request.
Image	2 Detailed	generated_images/level_2_imagegen.png	5	5	5	4	Brass robot, tomato plants, watering can and greenhouse are explicit and visible; warm light supports the requested setting.
Image	3 Style + camera	generated_images/level_3_imagegen.png	5	5	5	5	Cinematic lighting, shallow depth of field and left/right composition are clear.
Image	4 Structured	generated_images/level_4_imagegen.png	4	5	4	3	Subject and composition follow the fields, but the requested storybook watercolor reads closer to a realistic painterly image.

Medium	Level	Output	Quality	Prompt adherence	Coherence	Style match	Observation
Video	1 Simple	Grok Imagine, 6s at 480p; result remains in the signed-in Grok library	3	3	3	N/A	One browser sample generated for A robot watering plants. A visible frame showed a watering can and robot arm over a garden, but no full robot body; the 6-second player was available. The browser download remained incomplete, so no MP4 is included in the repository. Further generations were gated behind a INR 2,900/month plan; no subscription was started.
Video	2 Motion	Canva AI Video Clip	Not scored	Not scored	Not scored	N/A	Clip generated; preview showed a brass robot watering tomatoes in a warm greenhouse. MP4 download was blocked by Edge. Canva thread .
Video	3 Camera + timing	Canva AI Video Clip	Not scored	Not scored	Not scored	N/A	Clip generated without audio; Canva said exact 8-second duration is not controllable. Preview showed a robot watering tomatoes in a greenhouse. MP4 download was blocked by Edge. Canva thread .
Video	4 Shot list	Canva AI Video Clip	Not scored	Not scored	Not scored	N/A	Clip generated without audio. Canva described three requested beats, but a complete timeline could not be verified from the preview. MP4 download was blocked by Edge. Canva thread .

Scoring rubric

- Quality: visual clarity and artefacts (5 = strong).
- Prompt adherence: requested elements visibly present (5 = all major elements).
- Coherence: plausible anatomy and scene (5 = consistent).
- Style match: fit to requested style (5 = close). N/A when no style was specified.

Conclusion

For this four-image sample, adding subject details and action produced the clearest improvement over the short prompt. The camera and composition terms in level 3 were followed well. The structured style label was less reliable: the output looked more photographic than watercolor. One sample per image prompt cannot separate prompt effects from random variation. Video levels 1-4 were generated, but levels 2-4 used Canva after Grok's paid gate, so the cross-level video comparison is confounded by model differences. The Canva MP4 exports were blocked by Edge and are not stored in this repository; their signed-in result links are recorded in generated_videos/README.md.

Source: [Ex09_Image_Video_Prompting/prompt_anatomy.md](#)

Prompt anatomy: image and video

Image prompt formula

[Subject + key traits] + [Action/pose] + [Setting/background] + [Style/medium] + [Lighting] +
[Camera/composition] + [Colour/mood] + [Quality tags] + [Negative / exclusions]

Example: Small brass robot (subject) watering tomatoes with a copper can (action), Victorian greenhouse in morning fog (setting), watercolour illustration (style), soft god rays (lighting), medium shot, subject on left third (camera), warm greens and brass (colour), highly detailed (quality). Negative: text, watermark, extra limbs.

Video prompt formula

[Subject] + [Action/motion] + [Setting] + [Camera movement + shot size] + [Lighting/style] +
[Duration/pacing] + [Audio if supported] + [Consistency notes] + [Avoid]

Example: A brass robot waters tomato plants (subject+action) in a foggy greenhouse (setting); slow dolly-in, medium shot (camera); cinematic, warm light (style); 8 seconds (duration); soft ambient sound (audio); same robot design throughout (consistency); avoid text and morphing hands.

Vocabulary

Shot size: extreme wide, wide/establishing, medium, close-up, extreme close-up. **Angle:** eye level, low angle, high angle, bird's-eye, over-the-shoulder, Dutch tilt. **Camera movement:** static, pan, tilt, dolly in/out, tracking, truck, crane/jib, handheld, orbit, zoom, rack focus. **Lens/DOF:** wide-angle, 35 mm, 85 mm portrait, telephoto, macro, shallow or deep depth of field. **Motion words:** gentle sway, arcing water, slow-motion, time-lapse, drifting, accelerating, loop. **Lighting:** golden hour, backlight, rim light, soft diffuse, hard noon sun, volumetric/god rays, low key, high key. **Style:** photorealistic, cinematic, watercolour, anime-inspired, claymation, 3D render, documentary. Naming a living artist or copyrighted character raises ethical/policy issues; prefer generic style descriptions.

Levels used in this exercise

Level	Adds	Expected risk
1 Simple	subject only	model fills in everything randomly
2 Detailed / Motion	traits, setting, basic motion	style still random
3 Style+camera / Camera+timing	look, lens, camera move, duration	some elements may be ignored
4 Structured / Shot list	labelled fields or per-shot timing	best control; longer prompts can still lose details, video shot-by-shot may drift in character design

Video-specific tips

- One main action per shot; complex multi-step actions often fail.
- Describe camera movement separately from subject movement.
- Short clips (a few seconds) are more consistent than long ones.
- Repeat identical character description in every shot for consistency.
- Tool limits (max duration, audio support, shot lists) vary; check the tool's current docs.

Source: [Ex09_Image_Video_Prompting/prompts/image_prompts.md](#)

Image prompt levels (subject: a robot gardener)

Simple: A robot watering plants.

Detailed: A small friendly brass robot with rounded body and expressive round eyes waters tomato plants with a copper watering can in a Victorian greenhouse. Morning sunlight filters through glass panes; green leaves, red tomatoes, soft humidity, cozy warm palette. Medium shot, clear visible water stream, no writing or logos.

Style + camera: Cinematic 35mm photograph of a small brass gardener robot with rounded body and expressive eyes watering tomato plants with a copper can inside a misty Victorian greenhouse. Warm morning god rays through glass panes, water droplets sparkling, soft film grain, shallow depth of field, medium-wide composition with the robot on the left third and tomato vines on the right, no text, no logo.

Structured:

Subject: brass gardener robot, expressive round eyes
Action: watering tomatoes with a copper can
Setting: Victorian greenhouse, morning fog
Style: hand-painted storybook watercolor, warm and gentle
Lighting: soft god rays
Composition: medium shot, subject on left third
Negative: text, watermark, extra limbs, duplicated watering cans, distorted hands

The four image outputs were generated with the prompt text above. One sample was saved per level; no fixed seed was available.

Source: [Ex09_Image_Video_Prompting/prompts/video_prompts.md](#)

Video prompt levels (same subject)

Simple: A robot watering plants

Motion: A small brass robot waters tomato plants, water arcs from the can, leaves sway

Camera + timing: Slow dolly-in on a brass robot watering tomatoes in a foggy greenhouse; 8 seconds; light rays flicker; gentle ambient audio

Shot list:

Shot 1 (0-3s): wide, greenhouse in fog, robot enters frame left.

Shot 2 (3-6s): close-up, water pours, droplets catch light, shallow DOF.

Shot 3 (6-8s): robot looks up at camera and smiles; pull-back.

Style: cinematic, warm, 24fps. Consistency: same robot design in all shots. Avoid: text, morphing hands.

Source: [Ex09_Image_Video_Prompting/run_guide.md](#)

Step-by-step run guide

Pick one image tool (e.g. DALL-E, Stable Diffusion, Midjourney) and one video tool you have access to (e.g. Sora, Veo, Runway, Pika). Note tool, version, date.

Read `prompt_anatomy.md`; adapt the four levels in `prompts/image_prompts.md` and `prompts/video_prompts.md` if needed. Keep the subject identical across levels.

Image runs: use the same tool and, if possible, the same seed/aspect ratio for all four levels. Generate 1-3 variants per level.

Save files as `generated_images/<level>_<tool>.png`, e.g. `L1_dalle.png`, `L4_dalle.png`.

Video runs: use the same duration and aspect ratio for all levels. Save as `generated_videos/<level>_<tool>.mp4`.

Rate each output 1-5 in `evaluation.md` using the rubric. Rate before re-reading the expected-effect column to avoid bias.

Add notes on what was ignored, artefacts and consistency problems.

Compare with the expected-effect column; note where reality differed.

Write the conclusion; commit prompts, outputs and evaluation together.

If a tool does not support a feature (e.g. negative prompts or shot lists), write the exclusion in plain words and note this limit.

Appendix: Image Outputs

Ex09_Image_Video_Prompting/generated_images/level1_imagegen.png



Ex09_Image_Video_Prompting/generated_images/level2_imagegen.png



Ex09_Image_Video_Prompting/generated_images/level3_imagegen.png



Ex09_Image_Video_Prompting/generated_images/level4_imagegen.png

